DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
AIR FORCE RESEARCH LABORATORY
WRIGHT-PATTERSON AIR FORCE BASE OHIO

AFRLGM2026-63-01
30 September 2026

MEMORANDUM FOR ALL AFRL EMPLOYEES

FROM: AFRL/CC
1864 Fourth Street
Wright-Patterson AFB OH 45433-5001

SUBJECT: Air Force Research Laboratory (AFRL) Guidance Memorandum (GM) on AFRL Project Management

By Order of the Commander, Air Force Research Laboratory (AFRL), this guidance memorandum immediately establishes a common framework for project management across AFRL by defining project types, roles, responsibilities, and authorities to enable consistent execution, accountability, and delivery of mission outcomes. Compliance with this memorandum is mandatory. To the extent its directions are inconsistent with other Department of the Air Force/Air Force/Space Force publications, the information herein prevails, in accordance with Department of the Air Force Instruction (DAFI) 90-160, *Publications and Forms Management* and Department of the Air Force Manual (DAFMAN) 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*. This guidance applies to all mission organizations and detachments who will immediately begin implementation of this memorandum and ensure that all AFRL projects that are currently in execution have approved project baselines NLT 1 Oct 2026.

Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction (AFI) 33-322, Records Management and Information Governance Program, and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System.

If there are questions regarding the memorandum, please contact Mr. Matt Beck, AFRL/AQ, matthew.beck@us.af.mil.

DOUGLAS P. WICKERT
Brigadier General, USAF
Commander

Attachment:
AFRL Project Management Guidance

AFRL Project Management Guidance

1. PURPOSE. This guidance memorandum establishes a standardized, enterprise-wide framework for the planning, execution, and oversight of all AFRL projects. As the Air Force's primary science and technology organization, AFRL must maintain the highest standards of acquisition discipline to rapidly deliver decisive capabilities to the warfighter. By defining core terminology, key leadership roles, clear decision authority, and disciplined baseline requirements, this memorandum ensures that technical and scientific objectives are realistically aligned with sound business, contracting, and financial strategies.

2. CORE ELEMENTS: To ensure consistent execution, the following core terms have been defined to ensure a common language among collaborative teams across the enterprise.

   2.1 PROJECT: A finite endeavor undertaken and managed to create products, services, or results. Projects are planned and executed with AFRL appropriated funding and/or with money from external organizations. There are four categories of AFRL Projects: Technology Executive Officer (TEO) Oversight Projects, R&D Projects, R&D Support Projects, and Services Acquisition Projects.

   2.2 PROJECT MANAGEMENT: The application of tools, skills, strategies, and processes to plan, monitor, and execute projects. Project management ensures that decisions remain aligned to project objectives, enabling the effective delivery of relevant knowledge, technologies, and capabilities within approved baseline parameters.

   2.3 PROJECT TEAM: A multi-functional group of individuals, identified by the project manager, for the planning and execution of projects, including functional representation from finance, engineering, contracting, and others as needed.

3. KEY ROLES: Successful AFRL project execution relies on clearly defined roles, responsibilities, qualifications, and oversight functions of key project leaders.

   3.1 PROJECT MANAGER (PM): The individual, regardless of job series (civilian) or Air Force Specialty Code (military) designated as the individual responsible for managing a project's cost, schedule, and performance. The project manager leads the project team and is accountable for planning, executing, monitoring, and delivering project objectives in accordance with the approved acquisition strategy, project baseline, and risk assessment. A project manager is required to obtain, at a minimum, APDP Program Management (PM) practitioner certification or Engineering and Technical Management (ETM) practitioner certification depending on the individual's job series or specialty code.

   3.2 CHIEF OF MISSION EXECUTION (CME): The CME serves as the Program Management Organizational Senior Functional and senior Mission Execution lead within each Mission Organization (MO), enabling disciplined, aligned, and transparent project execution across the enterprise. The CME translates HQ guidance into MO-level project management practices, ensuring alignment between enterprise standards and day-to-day operations. CMEs are required to obtain APDP PM Advanced Certification. All CME

assignments require concurrence by the Program Management Center Senior Functional. The CME Guide provides further details.

3.3 DECISION AUTHORITY (DA): The designated decision authority for a project that is accountable for ensuring project executability. The DA is responsible for approving project strategies, plans, and decisions, such as project baselines and acquisition strategies, while providing oversight to support successful project execution, such as chairing project management reviews. The designated DA varies based on project type. See Table 1 in section 4 for guidance on DA delegation. DA delegations must be assigned by name, not position, based on the individual's project management experience and risk management experience.

4. DECISION AUTHORITY DELEGATION: To ensure proper mission execution oversight and risk alignment, project Decision Authority delegation shall be executed in accordance with the thresholds established in Table 1 below.

Table 1: AFRL Project Types and Approval Authorities.

Project Type	Description	Examples	DA
TEO Oversight Project	• Vanguard Projects • Designated by TEO	• NTS-3 • Rocket Cargo	TEO, delegable to MO Director
R&D Project	Projects that advance scientific knowledge, mature technologies, or develop capabilities	• The majority of AFRL projects	MO Director, delegable to CME, SML, Division Chief (DO/DR-IV, O-6), or ML
R&D Support Project	Enduring technical activities that support or grow the general technical capability of AFRL across multiple R&D projects	• Research/Test Labs (facilities/infrastructure, materials, etc.) • Modeling, Simulation, and Analysis (MS&A) activities • Lab hardware & software upgrades	MO Director or DET Commander, delegable to CME, SML, Division Chief (DO/DR-IV, O-6), or ML
Services Acquisition Project	Projects that acquire performance-based services to support operational, technical, and mission needs across AFRL.	• Professional services • IT services and support • Maintaining equipment and facilities	Decision Authority is governed by DAFI 63-138 and AFRL/CA memoranda

5. PROJECT PLANNING: To ensure that technical goals are realistically aligned with sound business and financial strategies, all AFRL projects must undergo a structured planning phase.

5.1 ACQUISITION STRATEGY (AS): All AFRL projects will have a DA-approved Acquisition Strategy prior to obligating funding for a project. The AS is comprehensive and describes the approach to be followed for planning and managing a project. It is not merely a contracting plan; rather, it serves as an overarching strategy that frames the

entire execution of the project, from initial resourcing to final deliverable. Developing a robust AS is critical, because it ensures that the project's technical goals are directly and realistically linked to a viable business and contracting approach. It serves as the bridge between the "what" (the project deliverable) and the "how" (the execution), forcing early, critical thinking about resources, schedule, funding, contracting methods, risk management, engineering, test planning, intellectual property, transition planning, and more. A well-defined AS prevents misaligned efforts, reduces project risks, and ensures the project is structured to deliver efficiently and effectively. The development of the AS is a collaborative effort involving the project manager, engineers, scientists, financial managers, contracting, and other key functional experts. Subject to the approval of the DA, project managers can streamline the content to match their project's needs provided the AS is realistic and executable.

5.2 PROJECT BASELINE: All AFRL projects will establish a project baseline prior to obligating funding for a project. Subject to approval by the DA, the Project Manager, in coordination with key stakeholders, establishes the project's baseline that will set the foundation of the project's performance and execution measures. The Project Baselining Guide provides more information on establishing, monitoring, and managing the project baseline, which consists of the following:

5.2.1. DELIVERABLE: The foundation of the project baseline is the documented scope of the expected project deliverable, defined as a unique product, service, or result. That deliverable can take many forms to include an integrated system, a prototype, hardware, software, material, or documented knowledge. Deliverables should have a defined transition partner and be described in measurable performance metrics, as practical.

5.2.2 COST: The cost baseline is the estimated total cost of the project for all monetary types, including all external money, across the total life of the project.

5.2.3 SCHEDULE: The schedule baseline is defined by key dates for event-driven project tasks. At a minimum, those key dates must include (1) the start date of the project (2) at least one event that can be used to assess schedule progress to achieving completion, and (3) the date of completion of the project.

5.2.4. BREACH CRITERIA: Criteria that define thresholds that trigger additional review to rebaseline or terminate activities as determined by the DA.

6. PROJECT OVERSIGHT & REVIEWS: Project oversight is achieved through Project Management Reviews (PMRs) which provide a structured mechanism for monitoring project progress, informing decision-making, and ensuring continued alignment with approved objectives, resources, and mission outcomes.

6.1 PROJECT MANAGEMENT REVIEWS: PMRs evaluate project performance relative to project baselines including risks, issues, and opportunities to determine whether a project

remains positioned to achieve its objectives. PMR structures may be tailored to the project's type, complexity, risk, technology maturity, transition requirements, and existing governance forums. In collaboration with the CME, the DA will determine the review cadence, participants, and decision-making forums used to assess project performance throughout execution. Each AFRL project shall conduct a PMR at least yearly.

6.2 PROJECT BASELINE BREACHES: When a project breaches or is anticipated to breach the established baseline criteria, the project manager must immediately notify the DA. PMRs provide a forum for evaluating corrective actions and/or rebaselining requirements. The DA serves as the primary approval authority for project oversight decisions and is responsible for adjudicating rebaselining requests and other significant project decisions.

7. ADDITIONAL RESOURCES: The attached Chief of Mission Execution (CME) Guide, Program Execution Group (PEG) Guide, Project Baselining Guide, and Project Management Review (PMR) Guide are provided to aid in compliant implementation. Adherence to these standards is vital to ensuring transparency, mitigating risks, and maintaining high-velocity mission capability delivery.

ATTACHMENTS:

- Chief of Mission Execution (CME) Guide
- Program Execution Group (PEG) Guide
- Project Baselining Guide
- Project Management Review (PMR) Guide

Chief of Mission Execution (CME) Guide

31 July 2026

INTRODUCTION

Guide Overview

This guide serves as a centralized resource for Chief of Mission Execution (CME) roles, responsibilities, and integration points across the enterprise. It establishes a common understanding of how CMEs lead and enable Mission Execution (ME), promoting clarity, consistency, and alignment across the Lab in support of AFRL's evolving mission needs.

How to Use This Guide

This guide is designed to help CMEs, Mission Organization (MO) leadership, and cross-functional partners understand and apply standardized ME practices across AFRL. It can be used to:

Onboard CMEs: Orient new CMEs to role expectations, ME operations, HQ alignment, battle rhythm, and communication pathways

Align Cross-Functional Teams: Clarify how the CME integrates with Program Management (AQ), Financial Management (FM/FZ), Contracting (PK/PZ), Engineering & Technical Management (EN), Integration & Planning (I&P), and other functional partners to support project execution and standardized ME practices

Guide Execution Oversight: Facilitate project execution and reviews, clarify ME processes, and promote consistent application of HQ requirements across MOs

MISSION EXECUTION (ME) OVERVIEW

What is Mission Execution?

Mission Execution (ME) strengthens AFRL project management by ensuring disciplined project planning, effective execution, and successful technology transition. ME encompasses three core elements:

Project Planning – establish a well-defined strategy, scope, estimate, and baseline to set projects up for success

Project Execution – monitor and assess cost, schedule, performance (CSP), and risk to ensure projects remain aligned with approved baselines and mission priorities

Project Transition – deliver high impact, mission relevant technology to the warfighter at the speed of relevance



Mission Execution is driven by collaboration and communications across the EN, FM, PM, and PK functionals

Chief of Mission Execution (CME) Guide

31 July 2026

WHO IS MISSION EXECUTION?

HQ Mission Execution

At the HQ level, Mission Execution is cross-functional collaboration among AQ, EN, FM, and PK and serves as the enterprise-wide ME function by establishing common standards, aligning MOs to HQ requirements, and promoting consistent execution practices across the Lab.

Mission Execution within Mission Organizations

Within each MO, ME ensures disciplined project planning, effective execution, and successful technology transition to include monitoring CSP and risk, supporting Planning, Programming, Budgeting, and Execution (PPBE) alignment, and communicating execution insights to leadership.

ME serves as the connective tissue between enterprise guidance, MO level governance, and day to day execution carried out by Project Managers and project teams. It provides both a framework and a set of behaviors that enable AFRL to operate with clarity, accountability, and consistency.



Who is the Chief of Mission Execution?

The CME serves as the senior Mission Execution lead within each Mission Organization (MO), enabling disciplined, aligned, and transparent project execution across the enterprise. The CME translates HQ Mission Execution guidance into MO-level project management and project execution practices, ensuring alignment between enterprise standards and day-to-day operations.

In this role, the MO CME:

- **Drives execution consistency** to improve clarity, accountability, and consistent project delivery across the MO
- **Shapes MO-level project management strategy and execution** to align MO operations with HQ mission priorities and project management policies
- **Integrates across functions** to execute governance, project oversight, risk management, and Program Execution Group (PEG) leadership within the MO
- **Serves as the PM Organizational Senior Functional** conducting PM workforce development to strengthen project management capabilities across the organization

Chief of Mission Execution (CME) Guide

31 July 2026

CHIEF OF MISSION EXECUTION RESPONSIBILITIES & AUTHORITIES

The CME is responsible for leading Mission Execution within the MO, integrating cross-functional execution activities, and exercising applicable decision authorities to support standardized and consistent project delivery.

ME Leadership

- Leads ME activities across the MO in alignment with Director priorities and HQ guidance
- Reinforces ME governance processes, standards, and review cycles
- Develops and oversees implementation of MO-level guidance supporting mission execution
- Coordinates with FM, PK, EN, I&P, Chief Scientists, and other stakeholders to drive project execution
- Provides direction to PEG operations to ensure alignment with enterprise ME structures
- Upward flow: Elevates risks, mission impacts, execution constraints, and baseline breaches/resolutions
- Downward flow: Implements enterprise guidance, governance expectations, and ME standards

PM Functional Leadership

- Serves as the Organizational Senior Functional for the Program Management career field
- Oversee PM workforce development, skill-building, and capability assessments
- Provides strategic direction and oversight to Project Managers

Project Baselining & Execution Oversight

- Reinforces standardized project management practices across the MO
- Guides project acquisition strategy development to include alignment with CSP, risk, and transition expectations
- Oversees baseline development and management across the MO in alignment with enterprise standards and acquisition requirements
- Ensures baselines (deliverable, cost, schedule) are documented, approved, maintained, and aligned with risk assessments
- Oversees replanning and approval processes if a baseline breach occurs
- Chairs recurring execution reviews and ensures visibility into project health
- Ensures positive communication with transition partners and project deliverable quality for transition
- Risk & Portfolio Management
  - Leads project risk management and mitigation oversight
  - Elevates execution risks, issues, resource constraints, and mission impacts to MO leadership and HQ ME, as necessary
  - Collaborates with I&P, FM, PK, and other functional partners to support resource informed execution decisions
  - Drives executable investment strategies, resource alignment, and portfolio level trade space decisions
  - Promotes integrated reporting, standardized dashboards, and data driven decision making

Approval & Decision Authorities

- Exercises Decision Authority (DA) responsibilities in accordance with HQ guidance, if delegated
- Approves applicable project baselines and acquisition strategies, if delegated

Program Execution Group (PEG) Guide

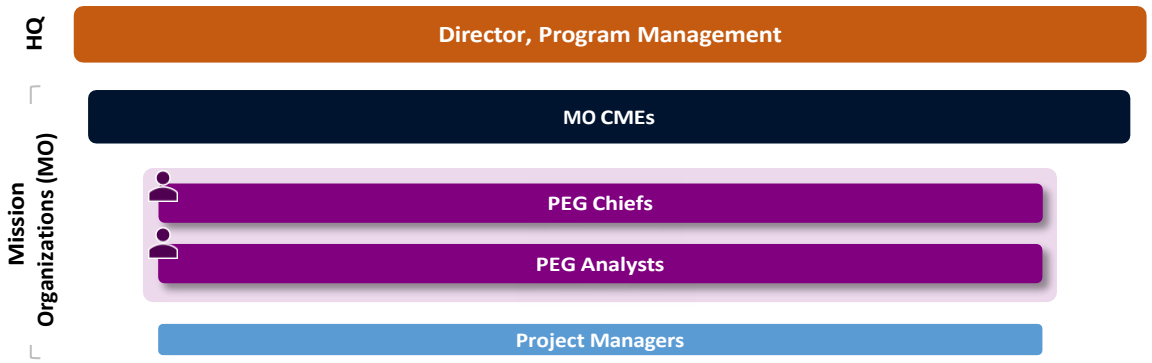
31 July 2026

PROGRAM EXECUTION GROUP (PEG) OVERVIEW

WHAT IS A PEG?

A Program Execution Group (PEG) is a Mission Organization (MO) group that coordinates and monitors project execution and operationalizes CME strategy and governance.

The PEG ensures that the Chief of Mission Execution's (CME) strategy and execution standards are properly integrated and operationalized at the MO level, maximizing mission success and protecting valuable technical resources. In addition to management of the MO's risk, cost, schedule, and performance, the PEG supports project execution by providing timely guidance and assistance to Project Managers by ensuring constant alignment with MO policy, guidance, practices, and review cycles.



WHO IS INVOLVED IN THE PEG?

PEG Chief:
Leads PEG activities and ensures alignment to priorities

PEG Analysts:
Executes PEG processes and analysis

FOUNDATIONAL FUNCTIONS

- **Mission Alignment & Benefits Realization:** Ensures clear traceability between mission priorities, portfolio objectives, and deliverables, and elevates any misalignment for governance action
- **Enterprise Integration (Up/Out & Down/In):** Synthesizes guidance across center, MOs, and division levels, tracks cross-project dependencies, and facilitates the upward and downward flow of insight and direction
- **Governance Operations & Decision Support:** Operates governance forums and decision pathways and standardizes decision packages
- **Portfolio Analysis & Execution Insight:** Assesses portfolio health and systemic risks, provides early warning indicators, and supports prioritization and reprioritization decisions
- **Standards, Methods & Execution Enablement:** Maintains execution standards, reporting structures, analytics frameworks, and data integrity while driving continuous improvement across processes and tools

Program Execution Group (PEG) Guide

31 July 2026

PEG REQUIREMENTS AND TRADE SPACE

Minimum requirements define the baseline components required for an MO-level PEG to ensure consistency across AFRL, while trade space defines where MOs have flexibility in implementation.

	PEG Requirements *Baseline components*	PEG Trade Space *Flexibility in implementation*
Structure & Staffing	❑ **Defined Scope:** MO PEG responsibilities are documented and aligned to project management policy and MO priorities ❑ **Distinct Leadership:** Accountable leadership is identified ❑ **Minimum Staffing:** Minimum PEG staffing model is established ○ PEG Chief: Leads PEG activities and ensures alignment to priorities ○ PEG Analysts: Execute PEG processes and support analysis	❑ **Team Design:** MOs may tailor PEG team size, composition, and role distribution based on mission complexity and resourcing ❑ **Roles Structure:** PEG roles may be structured as dedicated positions or integrated within existing functions ❑ **Work Distribution:** Responsibilities may be distributed differently across personnel, provided PEG requirements are covered
Operations & Governance	❑ **Repeatable Process:** A repeatable process exists to manage project prioritization, execution, reporting, and resourcing with standard outputs, including: ○ Project planning and strategy development ○ Project acquisition strategy approval processes ○ Baselining processes ○ Risk management processes ○ Periodic reviews (e.g., PMRs) ○ Performance dashboards/metrics	❑ **Tools & Platforms:** PEGs may leverage different tools and platforms to capture inputs, track outputs, and manage workflows, provided a standard tool is not established for the enterprise ❑ **Review Cycles:** Cadence and frequency of review cycles (e.g., monthly, quarterly) may vary based on MO-specific needs and battle rhythm ❑ **Operational Approach:** MOs may tailor approaches to prioritization, reporting, and analysis based on mission needs
Project Planning & Execution	❑ **Operational Integration:** PEG is integrated into the MO mission operations and enterprise governance structures ❑ **Planning Alignment:** PEG activities are aligned to MO priorities and enterprise planning cycles ❑ **Refinement:** Mission execution reviews and metrics are incorporated into feedback loops to inform planning and address evolving needs	❑ **Integration Model:** PEG integration may occur through existing governance structures or dedicated PEG forums ❑ **Planning Structure:** The level of formalization for integrating the PEG into planning and governance processes may vary by MO ❑ **Feedback Mechanisms:** Format and frequency of feedback may differ

Project Baselining Guide

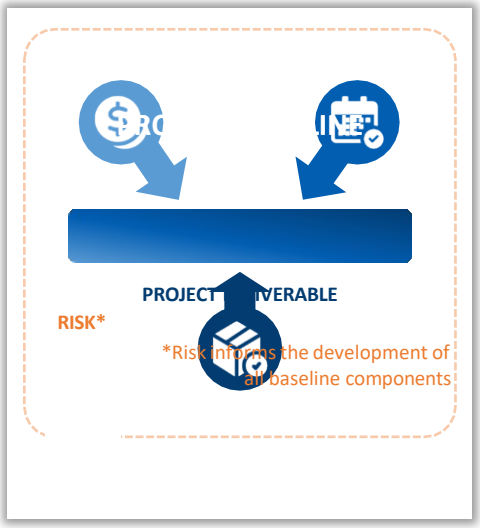
AFRL

31 July 2026

PROJECT BASELINING OVERVIEW

WHAT IS A PROJECT BASELINE?

A project baseline documents the approved project deliverable, cost, and schedule criteria required to accomplish a project's goals. It establishes the foundation for project execution by aligning resources, incorporating risk-informed planning, and defining the expectations against which project performance will be measured throughout execution.



WHY BASELINING MATTERS

- *Establishes a realistic and executable plan before project execution*
- *Aligns stakeholder expectations with realistic objectives*
- *Incorporates identified risks into cost and schedule planning*
- *Provides a basis for project oversight and decision-making*
- *Enables monitoring of project performance against approved expectations*
- *Supports resourcing, funding approval, and project authorization*

KEY ROLES

Project Manager: Develops and maintains the project baseline

Cross-Functional Team: Provides scientific, technical, engineering, financial, contracting, and planning inputs, as applicable

Decision Authority (DA): Reviews and approves project baselines

KEY COMPONENTS

Projects must have an approved baseline consisting of a project deliverable, cost, and schedule baseline prior to executing project funding. Subject to DA approval, the project manager defines a baseline meaningful to the project's complexity. The cost and schedule baselines must consist of a minimum threshold value and should include a desired objective.

COST BASELINE

Defines the total lifecycle project cost regardless of the source of funding

Baseline requirements:

- **Objective** = cost baseline value
- **Threshold** = no greater than 10% above the objective, as approved by the DA

SCHEDULE BASELINE

Defines key event-driven milestones used to measure project progress

Baseline requirements:

- **Objective** = estimated dates of key milestones including the final project deliverable completion
- **Threshold** = Delay in any key milestone that causes a delay to overall project completion of no greater than 3 months, as approved by the DA.

DELIVERABLE BASELINE

Defines the expected product, service, or result to be delivered

Baseline requirements:

- Scope and expected result of the project
- Defined transition partner, as applicable
- Performance objectives and thresholds may be required by the Decision Authority (DA), as applicable

RISK CONSIDERATIONS

Risk should be considered throughout baseline development. Identified technical, schedule, funding, and project risks should inform cost estimates, schedule assumptions, and mitigation planning. Cost and schedule baselines should be adjusted as appropriate based on risks and associated mitigation strategies to reduce the probability of a baseline breach.

REBASELINING

If breached, baseline thresholds provide a mechanism for identifying deviations that require PM-developed issue resolutions and DA oversight. In the event of a breach, or an expected breach, of any threshold, the PM must immediately notify the DA. Within 90 days, the PM must bring the project back within baseline or propose a revised baseline for DA approval.

Project Baselining Guide

AFRL

31 July 2026

BASELINING STEP-BY-STEP DEVELOPMENT

1. Define Project Deliverable

DELIVERABLE

- *Owner: Project Manager*
- *Support: Technical SME*

Key Activities:

- Define the expected product, service, or result (e.g., integrated system, prototype, software, documented knowledge, etc.)
- Establish justification and impact to transition partner/tech push
- Determine whether measurable performance characteristics apply
- Establish performance objectives and thresholds, if required by DA

***Output*:** *Project Deliverable Definition*

2. Develop Schedule

SCHEDULE

- *Owner: Project Manager*
- *Support: Cross-Functional Team*

Key Activities:

- Identify key tasks, activities, and dependencies
- Establish event-driven milestones
- Define project deliverable completion date
- Identify milestones used to assess progress

***Output*:** *Project Schedule*

3. Estimate Cost

COST

- *Owner: Project Manager*
- *Support: Finance , Technical SME*

Key Activities:

- Estimate the total cost for the duration of the project
- Include all funding sources and monetary types, including projected external funding

***Output*:** *Cost Estimate*

4. Align Budget & Resources

- *Owner: Project Manager*
- *Support: Finance, Technical SME*

Key Activities:

- Develop funding profile
- Develop phased spend plan
- Align resources to planned activities
- Assess funding availability and constraints
- Include all funding sources and monetary types, including projected external funding

***Output*:** *Funding Profile and Spend Plan*

5. Identify & Analyze Risk

- *Owner: Project Manager*
- *Support: Cross-Functional Team*

Key Activities:

- Identify technical, schedule, funding, and project risks
- Assess the likelihood and potential impact of identified risks
- Develop risk management strategies
- Evaluate impacts to cost estimates, milestones, & project execution
- Identify conditions that may require additional oversight or project rebaselining

***Output*:** *Risk Assessment and Mitigation Strategies*

6. Develop Project Baseline

- *Owner: Project Manager*
- *Support: Cross-Functional Team*

Key Activities:

- Re-evaluate baseline pillars of the project deliverable, cost, and schedule based on the risk analysis and adjust as appropriate.
- Consolidate planning outputs into a formal project baseline, documenting the cost, schedule, and project deliverable criteria that must be met to accomplish the project's goals
- Validate alignment across project deliverable, cost, schedule, funding, and risk assumptions

***Output*:** *Project Baseline*

7. Obtain DA Approval

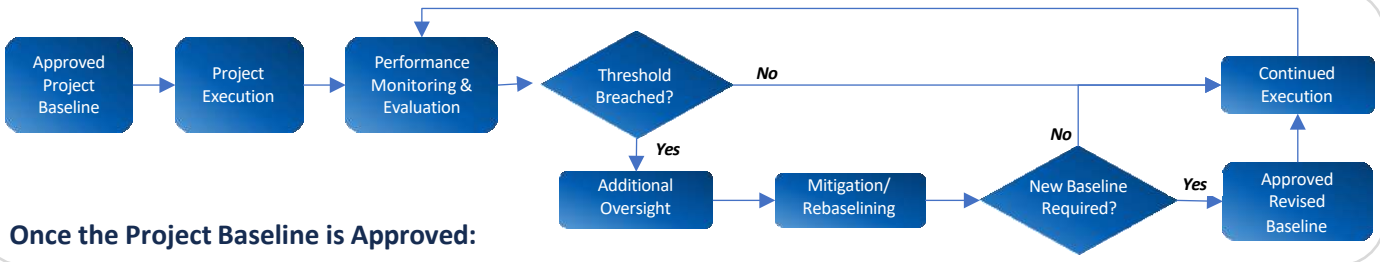
- *Owner: Decision Authority (DA)*
- *Support: Project Manager*

Key Activities:

- Review baseline assumptions
- Validate deliverable, cost, and schedule objectives and thresholds
- Ensure proper baseline tailoring based upon project complexity
- Approve project baseline prior to execution

***Output*:** *Approved Project Baseline*

Once the Project Baseline is Approved:



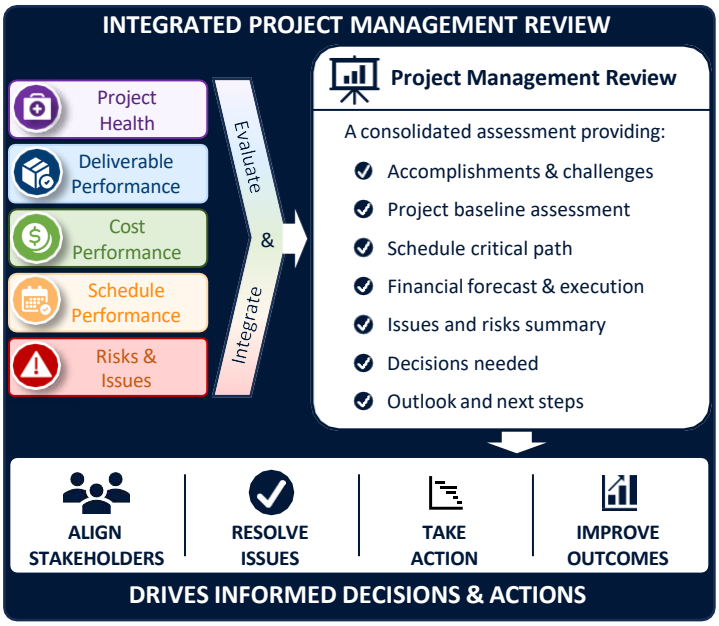
Project Management Review (PMR) Guide

31 July 2026

OVERVIEW

WHAT IS A PROJECT MANAGEMENT REVIEW?

A Project Management Review (PMR) is a structured governance forum used throughout project execution to evaluate project performance against the approved baseline, support leadership decision-making, and ensure continued alignment with project objectives, resources, and mission outcomes.



WHY DO PMRS MATTER

- *Enable informed leadership decisions through recurrent project performance assessments*
- *Improve project execution by evaluating risks, issues, and corrective actions early*
- *Maintain alignment with approved baselines, objectives, and mission outcomes*
- *Strengthen accountability through structured oversight and cross-functional collaboration*

PMRs assess project performance and risk relative to the approved project baseline to determine whether the project remains positioned to achieve its objectives. PMRs evaluate cost, schedule, and deliverable performance as well as overall project health to inform leadership decisions throughout project execution.

Area Assessed:	Project Health	Cost Performance	Schedule Performance	Deliverable Performance	Risks & Issues
Definition:	*Evaluates overall project health to identify factors that may impact successful project execution and inform leadership decisions*	*Evaluates execution against the approved cost baseline and budget forecast*	*Evaluates progress towards approved milestones and project completion*	*Evaluates progress toward the approved project deliverable(s)*	*Proactively evaluating and addressing threats to the project's success*
Data Provided: (Tailorable)	• Overall project manager assessment • Accomplishments • Challenges & barriers • Performance trend analysis • Stakeholder input • Need for corrective action or re-baselining	• Budget forecast, obligations, and expenditures • Cost variance • Projected cost at completion	• Progress towards milestones • Critical path • Schedule variance • Forecasted completion	• Technical progress • Deliverable maturity • Performance objectives (when applicable) • Transition readiness (when applicable)	• Risks & issues • Mitigation status • Dependencies & barriers

PMR ROLES

Decision Authority (DA):
The designated approval authority responsible for providing project oversight, chairing PMRs, and making key project decisions

Project Manager (PM):
The individual responsible for planning, executing, and delivering the project who presents during PMRs

Project Team:
The multi-functional team that provides scientific, technical, financial, engineering, contracting, integration, and planning, and other functional expertise to the assessment

Key Stakeholders:
Individuals or teams who participate to provide customer, operational, technical, or transition perspectives

Project Management Review (PMR) Guide

31 July 2026

PLANNING, DECISION FRAMEWORK, AND OUTCOMES

PMR PLANNING

The PM, in coordination with the Chief of Mission Execution (CME) and DA, establishes the PMR structure during project planning. This includes defining the review cadence, participants, decision-making forum, and tailoring approach based on the project's deliverables, complexity, risk profile, technology maturity, transition requirements, and governance needs. PMRs may be conducted as standalone reviews or incorporated into existing governance forums.

PMR DECISION FRAMEWORK

PMRs provide a structured forum for assessing project performance and determining the appropriate path forward throughout execution.

Every PMR should answer the following questions:

Is the project performing as planned?
Evaluate progress against the approved cost, schedule, and deliverable baselines.

Is project performance trending in a positive direction?
Evaluate performance over time using prior PMRs or other project status updates.

Is the project positioned for success?
Assess project health, including risks, issues, opportunities, dependencies, and barriers that may affect successful execution.

Does leadership action need to be taken?
Determine whether corrective actions, resource adjustments, or additional oversight are needed.

Can the project continue under the current baseline?
Determine whether performance remains within the approved baseline objectives, thresholds, and breach criteria.

PMR OUTCOMES

Every PMR should result in clear and documented decisions and actions that support continued project execution and inform future project oversight.

Continue Execution

Project performance remains aligned with approved baselines and execution continues as planned

Implement Corrective Actions

Leadership directs actions to address identified risks, issues, or performance variances

Increase Oversight

Additional reviews, reporting, or stakeholder engagement are required to improve performance or reduce execution risk

Evaluate Rebaselining

Performance no longer aligns with the approved baseline and the project continues to promise substantial return on investment

Evaluate Project Continuation

Performance no longer aligns with the approved baseline and the project requires further evaluation to descope/discontinue